

WORLD IN 1914 AND OUTBREAK OF WWI

ALLIANCE SYSTEM FORMATION → FOUR STRUCTURAL TENSIONS → BALKAN CRISIS LADDER → JULY TRIGGER AND FIRST → ESCALATION CHAIN → BALANCE-OF-POWER CASE

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g2 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

00

STAGE 00 ALLIANCE SYSTEM FORMATION

ALLIANCE SYSTEM FORMATION

TRIPLE ALLIANCE

GERMANY, AUSTRIA-HUNGARY, ITALY

FRANCE AND RUSSIA ALLY

ENTENTE CORDIALE

BRITAIN AND RUSSIA COMPLETE THE ENTENTE ALIGNMENT

MUST REMEMBER

ALLIANCE BLOCS, ARMS COMPETITION, IMPERIAL RIVALRY, NATIONALISM AND BALKAN

1882 → Triple Alliance: Germany, Austria-Hungary, Italy

1894 → France and Russia ally

1904 → Entente Cordiale

1907 → Britain and Russia complete the Entente alignment

MUST REMEMBER: Alliance blocs, arms competition, imperial rivalry, nationalism and Balkan crises created structural danger

CORE CLAIM

- 1882 → Triple Alliance: Germany, Austria-Hungary, Italy
- 1894 → France and Russia ally

MECHANISM

- 1904 → Entente Cordiale
- 1907 → Britain and Russia complete the Entente alignment

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- MUST REMEMBER: Alliance blocs, arms competition, imperial rivalry, nationalism and Balkan crises created structural danger
- Sarajevo was the trigger and the July Crisis converted a regional assassination into general war through state choices.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: MUST REMEMBER: Alliance blocs, arms competition, imperial rivalry, nationalism and Balkan crises created structural danger; Sarajevo was the trigger and the July Crisis converted a regional assassination into general war through state choices.

01

STAGE 01 FOUR STRUCTURAL TENSIONS

FOUR STRUCTURAL TENSIONS

NAVAL RACE

BRITAIN FEARS RELATIVE GERMAN SEA POWER

FRENCH REVANCHIST GRIEVANCE

GERMANY READS ENTENTE AS STRATEGIC PRESSURE

AUSTRIA AND RUSSIA COMPETE THROUGH SERBIA

NAVAL RACE → Britain fears relative German sea power

ALSACE-LORRAINE → French revanchist grievance

ENCIRCLEMENT → Germany reads Entente as strategic pressure

BALKANS → Austria and Russia compete through Serbia

CORE CLAIM

- NAVAL RACE → Britain fears relative German sea power
- ALSACE-LORRAINE → French revanchist grievance

MECHANISM

- ENCIRCLEMENT → Germany reads Entente as strategic pressure
- BALKANS → Austria and Russia compete through Serbia

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- NAVAL RACE → Britain fears relative German sea power
- ALSACE-LORRAINE → French revanchist grievance

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: BALKANS → Austria and Russia compete through Serbia.

02

STAGE 02 BALKAN CRISIS LADDER

BALKAN CRISIS LADDER

AUSTRIA-HUNGARY ANNEXES BOSNIA

AGADIR SHARPENS ANGLO-GERMAN MISTRUST

BALKAN WARS STRENGTHEN SERBIA

AUSTRIA SEEKS TO CURB SERBIAN NATIONALISM

1908 → Austria-Hungary annexes Bosnia

1911 → Agadir sharpens Anglo-German mistrust

1912-13 → Balkan Wars strengthen Serbia

1914 → Austria seeks to curb Serbian nationalism

CORE CLAIM

- 1908 → Austria-Hungary annexes Bosnia
- 1911 → Agadir sharpens Anglo-German mistrust

MECHANISM

- 1912-13 → Balkan Wars strengthen Serbia
- 1914 → Austria seeks to curb Serbian nationalism

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- 1908 → Austria-Hungary annexes Bosnia
- 1911 → Agadir sharpens Anglo-German mistrust

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: 1914 → Austria seeks to curb Serbian nationalism.

03

STAGE 03 JULY TRIGGER AND FIRST DECISION

JULY TRIGGER AND FIRST DECISION

28 JUNE

PRINCIP ASSASSINATES FRANZ FERDINAND AT SARAJEVO

AUSTRIA FRAMES DEMANDS SERBIA CANNOT FULLY ACCEPT

28 JULY

AUSTRIA-HUNGARY DECLARES WAR ON SERBIA

ASSASSINATION TRIGGERS; VIENNA CHOOSES WAR

28 JUNE → Princip assassinates Franz Ferdinand at Sarajevo

ULTIMATUM → Austria frames demands Serbia cannot fully accept

28 JULY → Austria-Hungary declares war on Serbia

RULE → assassination triggers; Vienna chooses war

CORE CLAIM

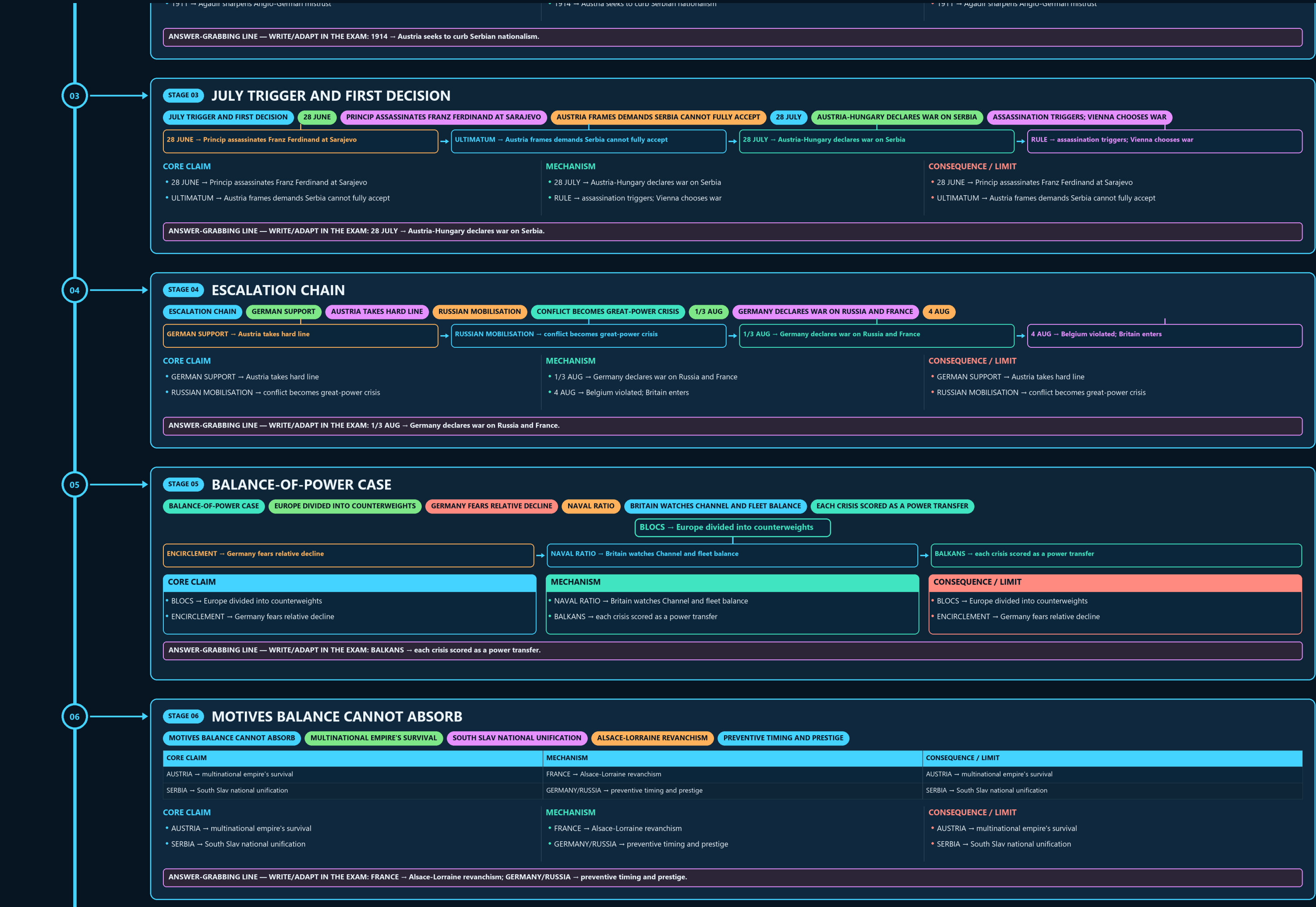
- 28 JUNE → Princip assassinates Franz Ferdinand at Sarajevo
- ULTIMATUM → Austria frames demands Serbia cannot fully accept

MECHANISM

- 28 JULY → Austria-Hungary declares war on Serbia
- RULE → assassination triggers; Vienna chooses war

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- 28 JUNE → Princip assassinates Franz Ferdinand at Sarajevo
- ULTIMATUM → Austria frames demands Serbia cannot fully accept



06

STAGE 06 MOTIVES BALANCE CANNOT ABSORB

MOTIVES BALANCE CANNOT ABSORB MULTINATIONAL EMPIRE'S SURVIVAL SOUTH SLAV NATIONAL UNIFICATION ALSACE-LORRAINE REVANCHISM PREVENTIVE TIMING AND PRESTIGE

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
AUSTRIA → multinational empire's survival	FRANCE → Alsace-Lorraine revanchism	AUSTRIA → multinational empire's survival
SERBIA → South Slav national unification	GERMANY/RUSSIA → preventive timing and prestige	SERBIA → South Slav national unification

CORE CLAIM - AUSTRIA → multinational empire's survival - SERBIA → South Slav national unification	MECHANISM - FRANCE → Alsace-Lorraine revanchism - GERMANY/RUSSIA → preventive timing and prestige	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT - AUSTRIA → multinational empire's survival - SERBIA → South Slav national unification
--	--	---

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: FRANCE → Alsace-Lorraine revanchism; GERMANY/RUSSIA → preventive timing and prestige.

07

STAGE 07 MOBILISATION AS MECHANISM

MOBILISATION AS MECHANISM RUSSIA MOBILISES GERMANY SEES NARROWING TIME GERMAN PLAN ATTACK FRANCE THROUGH BELGIUM MILITARY SEQUENCE COMPRESSES DIPLOMACY STRATEGIC PLANS WIDEN A REGIONAL WAR



CORE CLAIM - RUSSIA MOBILISES → Germany sees narrowing time - GERMAN PLAN → attack France through Belgium	MECHANISM - TIMETABLES → military sequence compresses diplomacy - RESULT → strategic plans widen a regional war	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT - RUSSIA MOBILISES → Germany sees narrowing time - GERMAN PLAN → attack France through Belgium
--	--	---

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RESULT → strategic plans widen a regional war.

08

STAGE 08 LIKELIHOOD VERSUS INEVITABILITY

LIKELIHOOD VERSUS INEVITABILITY BLOCS, ARMS, BALKAN CRISES AND MISTRUST NOT INEVITABLE 1905-06, 1908 AND 1911 WERE CONTAINED JULY LEADERS MAKE SPECIFIC RISKY CHOICES STRUCTURE RAISES DANGER; AGENCY STARTS WAR

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
LIKELY → blocs, arms, Balkan crises and mistrust	BREAK → July leaders make specific risky choices	LIKELY → blocs, arms, Balkan crises and mistrust
NOT INEVITABLE → 1905-06, 1908 and 1911 were contained	VERDICT → structure raises danger; agency starts war	NOT INEVITABLE → 1905-06, 1908 and 1911 were contained

CORE CLAIM - LIKELY → blocs, arms, Balkan crises and mistrust - NOT INEVITABLE → 1905-06, 1908 and 1911 were contained	MECHANISM - BREAK → July leaders make specific risky choices - VERDICT → structure raises danger; agency starts war	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT - LIKELY → blocs, arms, Balkan crises and mistrust - NOT INEVITABLE → 1905-06, 1908 and 1911 were contained
---	--	--

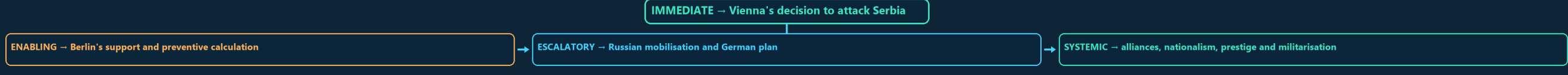
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → structure raises danger; agency starts war.

09

STAGE 09 RESPONSIBILITY AT TWO LEVELS

RESPONSIBILITY AT TWO LEVELS VIENNA'S DECISION TO ATTACK SERBIA BERLIN'S SUPPORT AND PREVENTIVE CALCULATION RUSSIAN MOBILISATION AND GERMAN PLAN ALLIANCES, NATIONALISM, PRESTIGE AND MILITARISATION CLOSE DISTINCTION

TRIPLE ENTENTE AND TRIPLE ALLIANCE WERE DIPLOMATIC ALIGNMENTS, NOT



CORE CLAIM - IMMEDIATE → Vienna's decision to attack Serbia - ENABLING → Berlin's support and preventive calculation	MECHANISM - ESCALATORY → Russian mobilisation and German plan - SYSTEMIC → alliances, nationalism, prestige and militarisation	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT - CLOSE DISTINCTION: Triple Entente and Triple Alliance were diplomatic alignments, not automatic identical war plans - Italy's 1914 position and later Ottoman and Bulgarian entry prevent a static two-camp map.
---	---	---

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE DISTINCTION: Triple Entente and Triple Alliance were diplomatic alignments, not automatic identical war plans; Italy's 1914 position and later Ottoman and Bulgarian entry prevent a static two-camp map.

TRIPLE ENTENTE AND TRIPLE ALLIANCE WERE DIPLOMATIC ALIGNMENTS, NOT

IMMEDIATE → Vienna's decision to attack Serbia

ENABLING → Berlin's support and preventive calculation

ESCALATORY → Russian mobilisation and German plan

SYSTEMIC → alliances, nationalism, prestige and militarisation

CORE CLAIM

IMMEDIATE → Vienna's decision to attack Serbia

ENABLING → Berlin's support and preventive calculation

MECHANISM

ESCALATORY → Russian mobilisation and German plan

SYSTEMIC → alliances, nationalism, prestige and militarisation

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

CLOSE DISTINCTION: Triple Entente and Triple Alliance were diplomatic alignments, not automatic identical war plans

Italy's 1914 position and later Ottoman and Bulgarian entry prevent a static two-camp map.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE DISTINCTION: Triple Entente and Triple Alliance were diplomatic alignments, not automatic identical war plans; Italy's 1914 position and later Ottoman and Bulgarian entry prevent a static two-camp map.

10

STAGE 10

ITALY AND BRITAIN TRAPS

ITALY AND BRITAIN TRAPS

ALLIANCE MEMBER BUT NEUTRAL IN 1914; ALLIES IN 1915

NO BINDING FRENCH ALLIANCE OBLIGATION

IMMEDIATE LEGAL-POLITICAL TRIGGER

ALIGNMENT, OBLIGATION AND ENTRY CAUSE ARE DIFFERENT

EVIDENCE LIMIT

GERMAN RISK-TAKING MATTERED, BUT A MONOCAUSAL GUILT STORY OBSCURES

AUSTRO-HUNGARIAN, RUSSIAN, FRENCH, BRITISH, SERBIAN AND IMPERIAL AGENCY AND

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
ITALY → Alliance member but neutral in 1914; Allies in 1915	BELGIUM → immediate legal-political trigger	EVIDENCE LIMIT: German risk-taking mattered, but a monocausal guilt story obscures
BRITAIN → no binding French alliance obligation	RULE → alignment, obligation and entry cause are different	Austro-Hungarian, Russian, French, British, Serbian and imperial agency and the difference between responsibility and inevitability.

CORE CLAIM

ITALY → Alliance member but neutral in 1914; Allies in 1915

BRITAIN → no binding French alliance obligation

MECHANISM

BELGIUM → immediate legal-political trigger

RULE → alignment, obligation and entry cause are different

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

EVIDENCE LIMIT: German risk-taking mattered, but a monocausal guilt story obscures

Austro-Hungarian, Russian, French, British, Serbian and imperial agency and the difference between responsibility and inevitability.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE → alignment, obligation and entry cause are different.

11

STAGE 11

OUTBREAK ANSWER SPINE

OUTBREAK ANSWER SPINE

SARAJEVO, 28 JUNE

AUSTRO-SERB NATIONALITY CONFLICT

SUPPORT, MOBILISATION, BELGIUM

BALANCE STRUCTURE PLUS DISTINCT MOTIVES AND CHOICES

TRIGGER → Sarajevo, 28 June

REGIONAL → Austro-Serb nationality conflict

ESCALATION → support, mobilisation, Belgium

VERDICT → balance structure plus distinct motives and choices

CORE CLAIM

TRIGGER → Sarajevo, 28 June

REGIONAL → Austro-Serb nationality conflict

MECHANISM

ESCALATION → support, mobilisation, Belgium

VERDICT → balance structure plus distinct motives and choices

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

TRIGGER → Sarajevo, 28 June

REGIONAL → Austro-Serb nationality conflict

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → balance structure plus distinct motives and choices.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT

THE AUSTRO-SERB QUARREL SPARKED THE WAR

GERMAN BACKING OF AUSTRIA WAS CRUCIAL

RUSSIAN POLICY AND REARMAMENT ALSO HELPED MAKE GERMANY FEEL

USE THE OUTBREAK OF WAR AS THE SETTING FOR

CROSS-LINK INSTEAD OF DUPLICATING

MODERN-INDIAN-HISTORY/BASIC/18 WWI-HOME-RULE-AND-LUCKNOW-PACT.MD AND BASIC/19 GANDHIS-RISE-ROWLATT-AND-JALLIANWALA.MD.

IN ANSWERS, ONE SENTENCE IS ENOUGH

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH

the Austro-Serb quarrel sparked the war;

German backing of Austria was crucial;

Russian policy and rearmament also helped make Germany feel pressed toward risk.

CAUTION: Use the outbreak of war as the setting for later Indian wartime expectations of reform, loyalty and postwar disappointment.

ADVANCED DEBATE

CAUTION: Cross-link instead of duplicating: Modern-Indian-History/basic/18 WWI-Home-Rule-and-Lucknow-Pact.md and basic/19 Gandhis-Rise-Rowlatt-and-Jallianwala.md.

CAUTION: In answers, one sentence is enough: the war globalized European conflict and

pulled colonies into a crisis whose political after-effects were felt far beyond Europe.

Sarajevo assassination: 28 June 1914.

LEGACY / NUANCE

Russia ordered general mobilization after Austria moved on Serbia.

German support for Austria is described by Lowe as a "blank cheque".

Belgian neutrality brought Britain directly into war.

Lowe discusses Fischer, Zuber, Turner and Mulligan within the blame debate.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.